

Leave Guidelines

Last Updated: July 2017

Types of Leave

It is recognised that it is important for the health and well-being of all staff that we should take regular breaks from duty. All provisions are subject to Conditions of Service and operational needs, and work alongside the [BBC Leave Policy](#).

Annual Leave and Public Holiday Leave

The leave year runs from **1st April to 31st March**. During that time, you have the following Leave Credits to take:

200 hours of paid **Annual Leave**

72 hours of paid **Public Holiday Leave** (known as PHL) (currently there is a separate provision for those based in the Global team)

These figures are for full-time workers. Part-time workers' figures are pro-rata.

All Annual Leave must be taken by 31st March. 72 hours (a full year's PHL allowance) may be carried over into the next year (part-time workers pro rata). If you foresee a problem with using up your leave, please speak with your manager in good time so that you can be helped to achieve this.

In addition to your Annual and Public Holiday leave, the following options are available:

Compensatory Leave and EDP

Staff working over their contracted hours can be paid in money (EDP) **or** choose to reclaim the hours as a mixture of Compensatory Leave and a smaller financial payment. If you are a full-time worker, or a part-time worker who has worked some hours over full-time, for your hours over full-time, your EDP money would be paid as 1.5 x your hourly rate and your Comp Leave hours would be awarded as 1 x your Comp Leave hours + 0.5 x Comp Leave hours as money.

If you are a part-time worker and you work extra hours, for your hours up to full-time hours, your EDP money would be paid as 1 x your hourly rate and your Comp Leave hours would be awarded as 1 x your Comp Leave hours. So there is no financial payment alongside your Comp Leave.

Comp Leave operates independently of the leave year, and must be used within 3 months of it being earned. To take Comp Leave, you must notify the Office, and your Comp Leave hours will be added to your normal leave "clicks". If there is any associated money owed, it will come to you in your Payslip email at the beginning of the month, along with your night hours and other allowances.

Additional Leave

Additional Leave is granted to staff who joined before 1st January 2013, and who have completed 10 years' or more service with the BBC. These staff are entitled to an extra half a week of additional leave for every year (**20 hours** for full-time workers, pro rata for part-time workers), starting in the leave year which includes the 10th anniversary. It is intended to enable staff to have the opportunity of taking a reasonably long break from duty at least once in their BBC career, and can be accumulated up to a maximum of 8 weeks (**320 hours** for full-time workers, pro rata for part-time workers).

Taking Additional Leave should not be seen as an alternative to annual leave, and may not normally be taken in this way. However, if there are special reasons which make accumulation inappropriate, staff may be allowed to take their additional leave at more frequent intervals of not less than 1 week at a time. Up to two weeks of Additional Leave can be entered into the normal leave "clicks" system by the Office. For periods longer than that, you must speak with your Line Manager. Because of the nature of additional leave, pay in lieu is not normally granted on leaving the BBC.

Long Service Leave

Long Service Leave is granted to staff on the day they complete 25 years' service with the BBC. Staff are offered the choice of 5 weeks of leave or 5 weeks' worth of salary, and choose one of those options, or a mixture of both adding up to 5 weeks' worth. If you have any part-time working as part of your 25 years' service, then the amount will be adjusted pro rata.

Long Service Leave must be taken before the end of the calendar year following that in which 25 years' service was completed, or before retirement, whichever is earlier. This leave is managed outside of the leave system.

Leave Availability

Guaranteed Leave

More than 42 days in the future from now (more than 35 days for Global) a number of guaranteed days/nights of leave are available to each team. The exact number of days/nights for each day is shown in brackets after the date on the "Leave by Week" view:

15 Mar 2017 Wednesday (5)

These figures may be adjusted in specific weeks to cope with operational or business needs, and special arrangements are always in place for the Christmas/New Year period and over the Summer.

Leave given out at the Office's discretion

There are two types of leave given out at the office's discretion:

- 1) Short Notice Leave – sometimes it is possible to give out leave after the days on and off have been set. You can request this on the website, but it is not guaranteed and depends on operational availability.
- 2) Advance Leave – sometimes it is possible to give out leave in advance over and above the guaranteed figures. The office will compare the number of people who are down to be in work on any given day with the number of shifts we normally need on that day. For instance, if on that day we are 3 shifts up (i.e. there are 3 more people due in work than is needed), then the possibility of extra leave being granted would be pretty good. On the other hand, if we are already short of people on that day, then it is unlikely that leave will be granted.

*35 days for those based in the Global team

What happens if someone is sick on their Leave days?

If you are sick during your leave you can claim back your leave hours, as long as you have a doctor's note covering the relevant dates. For any dates covered by the sick note, we will enter "Sick" absence on your allocations record, and your Leave hours will be returned to you. As per BBC Policy, you must obtain and show a doctor's note, even if it is only for one day, and only dates covered by the doctor's note will have their Leave hours returned.

Times of Year when there is Heavy Demand for Leave

Special processes are put in place in order to allocate time away over the Summer and Christmas/New Year periods in the most equitable way possible.

Summer Leave

The Summer Leave periods run as follows:

London	June 10 th – September 30 th
Salford	July 1 st – September 30 th

Until 31st March of any given calendar year, any individual may only book ten clicks (part-timers pro-rata) within the upcoming Summer Leave period. This allows as many people as possible to take leave during the summer months.

In addition, there is the facility to enter more than ten clicks. These turn purple and are held back in a separate area. This allows other people who have not yet entered all their first ten clicks to take priority for the available leave.

On 1st April, a few months before the Summer Leave period itself, two things happen:

Firstly, the purple clicks are released from their holding area. They appear below any existing requests, including grey waiting list requests from other people who have used their first ten clicks to make those requests.

Secondly, the “ten clicks” restrictions are lifted, and individuals are free to book as much leave as is available within those months, subject to their own leave balance.

Christmas and New Year Leave and Requests

The Christmas and New Year period varies slightly each year, but is normally approximately **December 20th – January 2nd**. Over this time, no guaranteed leave slots are available on a first-come, first-served basis, but requests can be entered as normal on the website. They will all go grey.

Some guaranteed leave is given out in advance (normally in early Summer) according to a system of points. There is no limit to the amount of leave any individual can take, provided they have enough points, and the personal leave balance to cover it. Where possible, the process set out below under “One Shift Missing from a Block of Leave” will be observed, but there will be occasions when it’s not possible during this time.

Later in the year, requests can be submitted (normally in October), covering early and late shifts, days off, and offering to work extra shifts. These are granted where possible, but will always be subject to operational requirements.

It is sometimes possible to give out leave over and above the guaranteed slots at the last minute, due to the schedule changes associated with Christmas. This extra leave is awarded using points and operational requirements, and can be granted as late as the week of Christmas itself.

Everyone gets one **Christmas Cracker** that they can use to indicate their one most important request over the season. The Office will use this information when processing the requests at every stage of the process. The Christmas Cracker can be used for any type of request – Leave, Shift Time, or Day Off – and the way to indicate that you want this one request to be your Christmas Cracker is to write “Christmas Cracker” in the comments field of the request.

How to earn Christmas Points

Points are awarded according to the work carried out over the Christmas and New Year periods of the previous three years. There are Basic Points and Additional Points. Basic points are awarded according to the day that the shift starts. Additional points are awarded on an actuality basis according to the exact time that the shift is worked.

One Basic Point is awarded for each of the following days: 24th, 27th, 28th, 29th, 30th, 31st December.

Two Basic Points are awarded for each of the following days: 25th, 26th December and 1st January.

Additional Points are available on the following days according to the exact timing of the shift: 24th, 25th, 26th, 31st December and 1st January.

Christmas Points are viewed on the Allocate Website, under Leave. A key is available at the top of the page, where the exact breakdown of the points is explained.

If someone is on attachment within the BBC in one or more of those years, their points will be calculated and added into their total as if they were working in the Prod Ops Audio team.

One Shift Missing from a Block of Leave

For guaranteed leave bounded by days off, with a single day still grey, and ahead of the days on and off being set (ie further into the future than the light blue Short Notice dates):

- If you have **4 working days/nights** bounded by days off, and you can get 3 of them as guaranteed leave, then the fourth is also guaranteed.
- If you have **5 working days/nights** bounded by days off, and you can get 4 of them as guaranteed leave, then the fifth is also guaranteed.
- If you have **6 working days/nights** bounded by days off, and you can get 5 of them as guaranteed leave, then the sixth is also guaranteed.
- If you have **8 – 12 working days/nights** bounded by days off, and across those working days you have a total of two guaranteed shifts missing, then the two missing shifts are also guaranteed. It doesn't matter where in the working days the missing guaranteed shifts fall.

Only patterns bounded by days off qualify, and patterns of 3 or 2 working days/nights do not follow this pattern – a pattern of 4 is the minimum number to attract this extra guaranteed time.

For an individual, it's important to note that you must enter a "grey" request on the missing day. If you don't, it will be assumed that you don't want a solid block of leave, and are happy with a working day in the middle of your block of leave.

Examples:

Mon, Tues	days off
Weds, Thurs, Fri, Sat, Sun	guaranteed leave
Mon, Tues	days off
Weds, Thurs	grey THIS WOULD AUTOMATICALLY BE GRANTED
Fri, Sat, Sun	guaranteed leave
Mon, Tues	days off

For part-timers, the number of working days must be the same, but it is possible to have extra days off inside the bounded period. For instance, in the following scenario, the Saturday would be automatically guaranteed as leave – Weds, Thurs, Sat, Sun are treated as if they are a four-day pattern, with the Friday in the middle ignored. The whole leave period is bounded by days off on the Mondays and Tuesdays.

Mon, Tues	days off
Weds, Thurs	guaranteed leave
Fri	day off
Sat	grey THIS WOULD AUTOMATICALLY BE GRANTED
Sun	guaranteed leave
Mon, Tues	days off